ever, is conceived in absolutist as well as in theistic terms; the latter forms the basis of *Bhakti-yoga,* or dedication of all work to the Lord.

THE CHĀRVĀKA

This heterogeneous material perhaps could not long remain without systematization, hence, the transition to systems. First comes the *Chārvāka,* or the *Lokāyata,* that is, the commonsense philosophy restricted to the world of common experience. This is regarded as one of the heterodox or non-Vedic systems as it believes neither in revelation nor in the authority of the *Vedas.* Things, it maintains, have no transcendental essence: they are what they appear to be. Only the perceived elements—earth, water, fire, and air—are real. Supersensible entities, like God, soul, and the divine origin of the *Vedas* are ridiculed. Perception being the only source of knowledge, life is to be taken as it is, a mixture of pain and pleasure. It is vain to strive after a painless existence: Wisdom is maximizing the balance of pleasure over pain. Yet the system does not recommend purely animalistic living. It may be taken as an earlier counterpart to Western Epicureanism.

JAINISM

Another non-Vedic religion is Jainism. Its name is derived from the word *Jin,* meaning the conquest of life's suffering. It is older than Hinduism or Buddhism. Its founder was Riṣabha, the first *Tirthānkara,* or perfect soul (Lord Mahavīra being the last of the series of *Tirthānkaras).* Its two well-known sects are the *Śvetāmbaras* (the white-clad) and the *Digāmbaras* (the sky-clad). Their central philosophy, however, is the same.

Jain metaphysics is both dualistic and pluralistic. The animate and inanimate, or the *Jīva* and *Ajīva,* are both treated as eternal, independent, and numberless. The *Jīva,* meaning only the individual soul and not the supreme Self of the *Upaniṣads,* is always mixed up with matter except when liberated. It may be mobile or immobile as in stones, but *Cetana* (consciousness) is its chief quality. It is by nature ever active to perfect itself: the *Tirthānkaras* are these perfected souls. Most of the functions of God are attributed to the *Jīva's* potential power. It may be *Mukta* (liberated) or *Baddha* (in bondage). The former has the usual characteristics of perfect knowledge, power, and bliss.